

5K Training Plan

12-Week Beginner Program

Program Details

Distance:	5 kilometers (3.1 miles)
Duration:	12 weeks
Level:	Beginner
Training Days:	3-4 days per week

Program Overview

This 12-week beginner 5K training plan is designed for complete beginners who want to build up to running 5 kilometers (3.1 miles) continuously. The program uses a gradual run/walk progression that safely builds your endurance while minimizing injury risk. By the end of this program, you will be able to run a full 5K race.

Training Phases

- Weeks 1-4: Foundation Phase - Build basic fitness with run/walk intervals
- Weeks 5-8: Build Phase - Increase running duration, reduce walking
- Weeks 9-11: Peak Phase - Longer continuous runs with speed work
- Week 12: Race Week - Taper and race day

Weekly Training Schedule

Week 1							
Day	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
1	Walk/Run	Cross	Rest	Walk/Run	Cross	Walk/Run	Rest
	10x30s	20m		10x1m	20m	12x1m	

Week 2							
Day	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
2	Walk/Run	Cross	Rest	Walk/Run	Cross	Walk/Run	Rest
Week 3							
Day	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
3	Walk/Run	Cross	Rest	Walk/Run	Cross	Walk/Run	Rest
Week 4							
Day	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
4	Walk/Run	Cross	Rest	Walk/Run	Cross	Easy	Rest
Week 5							
Day	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
5	Easy	Cross	Rest	2x10m	Cross	Easy	Rest
Week 6							
Day	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
6	Easy	Cross	Rest	Speed	Cross	2x15m	Rest
Week 7							
Day	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
7	Easy	Cross	Rest	Speed	Cross	Easy	Rest
Week 8							
Day	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
8	Easy	Cross	Rest	Speed	Cross	Easy	Rest
	2.5mi	45m		5m+10x1m	20m	3mi	

Week 9							
Day	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
9	Easy	Cross	Rest	Speed	Cross	3mi+	Rest
Week 10							
Day	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
10	Easy	Cross	Rest	Speed	Cross	3mi+	Rest
Week 11							
Day	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
11	Easy	Cross	Rest	Speed	Cross	Easy	Rest
Week 12							
Day	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
12	Easy	Cross	Speed	Rest	Easy	Rest	5K RACE
	3mi	35m	2x5m		15m		

Workout Definitions

Walk/Run: Alternate between running and walking. For example, "10x30s run/1min walk" means run for 30 seconds, walk for 1 minute, repeat 10 times.

Easy Run: Run at a comfortable, conversational pace. You should be able to hold a conversation while running.

Cross Training: Low-impact cardio such as cycling, swimming, elliptical, or brisk walking.

Speed Work: Higher intensity intervals to build speed. Run the hard portions at a challenging but sustainable pace.

Rest: Complete rest day. No running or intense exercise.

Nutrition Guidelines

- Stay hydrated: Drink water throughout the day
- Pre-run fuel: Eat a light snack 1-2 hours before running
- Post-run recovery: Consume protein and carbs within 30 minutes
- Race day: Stick to familiar foods

Injury Prevention

- Warm up with 5 minutes of walking before each run
- Cool down with 5 minutes of walking after each run
- Stretch major muscle groups after running
- Increase weekly mileage by no more than 10% per week
- Listen to your body - take extra rest if needed